Text 1

第 1 段

France, which prides itself as the global innovator of fashion, has decided its fashion industry has lost an absolute right to define physical beauty for women. Its lawmakers gave preliminary approval last week to a law that would make it a crime to employ ultra-thin models on runways. The parliament also agreed to ban websites that "incite excessive thinness" by promoting extreme dieting.

直译：法国以全球时尚创新者自居，如今却认定，本国时尚业已经失去定义女性形体美的绝对权利。上周，法国立法者初步批准了一项法律：雇用极度瘦削的模特走秀将被认定为犯罪。议会还同意禁止那些通过宣扬极端节食而 " 煽动过度消瘦 " 的网站。

第 2 段

Such measures have a couple of uplifting motives. They suggest beauty should not be defined by looks that end up impinging on health. That's a start. And the ban on ultra-thin models seems to go beyond protecting models from starving themselves to death —as some have done. It tells the fashion industry that it must take responsibility for the signal it sends women, especially teenage girls, about the social tape-measure they must use to determine their individual worth.

直译：这些措施背后有两个令人鼓舞的动机。它们表明，不应以最终会损害健康的外貌来定义美。这是一个开端。而对极瘦模特的禁令，似乎不只是要防止模特把自己饿死——有些模特确实已经如此。它还告诉时尚业，该行业必须为自己向女性、尤其是少女传递的信号负责；这种信号涉及她们必须用来衡量个人价值的那把社会 " 卷尺 "。

第 3 段

The bans, if fully enforced, would suggest to women (and many men) that they should not let others be arbiters of their beauty. And perhaps faintly, they hint that people should look to intangible qualities like character and intellect rather than dieting their way to size zero or wasp-waist physiques.

直译：这些禁令如果得到全面执行，将向女性以及许多男性表明：他们不应让别人裁定自己是否美丽。也许这些禁令还隐约暗示，人们应该重视品格、才智等无形的品质，而不是靠节食把自己变成零号身材或蜂腰体形。

第 4 段

The French measures, however, rely too much on severe punishment to change a culture that still regards beauty as skin-deep —and bone-showing. Under the law, using a fashion model that does not meet a government-defined index of body mass could result in a $85,000 fine and six months in prison.

直译：然而，法国的措施过于依赖严厉惩罚，来改变一种仍把美看作只在皮肤表面、甚至以骨瘦如柴为美的文化。根据该法律，雇用不符合政府规定的身体质量指数的时装模特，可能导致八万五千美元罚款以及六个月监禁。

第 5 段

The fashion industry knows it has an inherent problem in focusing on material adornment and idealized body types. In Denmark, the United States, and a few other countries, it is trying to set voluntary standards for models and fashion images that rely more on peer pressure for enforcement.

直译：时尚业知道，将注意力集中于物质装饰和理想化体形，本身就存在固有问题。在丹麦、美国以及另外少数几个国家，该行业正试图为模特和时尚形象制定自愿遵守的标准，并更多依赖同行压力来执行这些标准。

第 6 段

In contrast to France's actions, Denmark's fashion industry agreed last month on rules and sanctions regarding the age, health, and other characteristics of models. The newly revised Danish Fashion Ethical Charter clearly states: "We are aware of and take responsibility for the impact the fashion industry has on body ideals, especially on young people." The charter's main tool of enforcement is to deny access for designers and modeling agencies to Copenhagen Fashion Week (CFW), which is run by the Danish Fashion Institute. But in general it relies on a name-and-shame method of compliance.

直译：与法国的行动形成对照的是，丹麦时尚业上个月就模特的年龄、健康及其他特征，商定了相关规则与处罚措施。新修订的《丹麦时尚伦理宪章》明确写道："我们意识到时尚业对理想体形观念的影响，尤其是对年轻人的影响，并为此承担责任。"该宪章主要的执行工具，是禁止违规设计师和模特经纪机构参加由丹麦时尚研究所主办的哥本哈根时装周（CFW）。但总体来说，它依靠的是点名批评、使违规者蒙羞的办法来促使人们遵守规定。

第 7 段

Relying on ethical persuasion rather than law to address the misuse of body ideals may be the best step. Even better would be to help elevate notions of beauty beyond the material standards of a particular industry.

直译：依靠道德劝说而不是法律，来处理理想体形观念被滥用的问题，可能是最佳举措。更好的做法，则是帮助人们把美的观念提升到某个特定行业的物质标准之上。

Text 2

第 1 段

For the first time in history more people live in towns than in the country. In Britain this has had a curious result. While polls show Britons rate “the countryside” alongside the royal family, Shakespeare and the National Health Service (NHS) as what makes them proudest of their country, this has limited political support.

直译：历史上第一次，居住在城镇的人多于居住在乡村的人。在英国，这产生了一个奇特的结果。虽然民意调查显示，英国人把“乡村”与王室、莎士比亚以及国民医疗服务体系（NHS）并列，视为最令他们为自己的国家感到自豪的事物，但保护乡村获得的政治支持却很有限。

第 2 段

A century ago Octavia Hill launched the National Trust not to rescue stylish houses but to save “the beauty of natural places for everyone forever.” It was specifically to provide city dwellers with spaces for leisure where they could experience “a refreshing air.” Hill’s pressure later led to the creation of national parks and green belts. They don’t make countryside any more, and every year concrete consumes more of it. It needs constant guardianship.

直译：一个世纪以前，奥克塔维娅·希尔创立国民信托组织，不是为了拯救漂亮的房屋，而是为了“让每个人永远享有自然之地的美”。它尤其是为了给城市居民提供休闲场所，使他们能在那里感受到“清新的空气”。希尔施加的压力后来促成了国家公园和绿化带的建立。人们无法再制造更多乡村，而混凝土每年都在吞噬更多乡村土地。乡村需要持续的守护。

第 3 段

At the next election none of the big parties seem likely to endorse this sentiment. The Conservatives’ planning reform explicitly gives rural development priority over conservation, even authorising “off-plan” building where local people might object. The concept of sustainable development has been defined as profitable. Labour likewise wants to discontinue local planning where councils oppose development. The Liberal Democrats are silent. Only Ukip, sensing its chance, has sided with those pleading for a more considered approach to using green land. Its Campaign to Protect Rural England struck terror into many local Conservative parties.

直译：在下次选举中，各大政党似乎都不太可能支持这种情感。保守党的规划改革明确把乡村开发置于保护之上，甚至批准那些当地居民可能反对的“规划外”建设。可持续发展这一概念已经被定义为能带来利润的发展。工党同样希望在地方议会反对开发的地区停止地方规划。自由民主党保持沉默。只有英国独立党察觉到了机会，站到了那些呼吁以更审慎的方式使用绿地的人一边。它的保护英格兰乡村运动使许多地方保守党组织感到恐惧。

第 4 段

The sensible place to build new houses, factories and offices is where people are, in cities and towns where infrastructure is in place. The London agents Stirling Ackroyd recently identified enough sites for half a million houses in the London area alone, with no intrusion on green belt. What is true of London is even truer of the provinces.

直译：建设新住房、工厂和办公室的合理地点，是人口所在之处，是已有基础设施的城市和城镇。伦敦房地产中介斯特林·阿克罗伊德最近发现，仅在伦敦地区，就有足够建造五十万套住房的土地，而且不必侵占绿化带。伦敦如此，外省地区更是如此。

第 5 段

The idea that “housing crisis” equals “concreted meadows” is pure lobby talk. The issue is not the need for more houses but, as always, where to put them. Under lobby pressure, George Osborne favours rural new-build against urban renovation and renewal. He favours out-of-town shopping sites against high streets. This is not a free market but a biased one. Rural towns and villages have grown and will always grow. They do so best where building sticks to their edges and respects their character. We do not ruin urban conservation areas. Why ruin rural ones?

直译：把“住房危机”等同于“把草地铺成混凝土”，纯粹是游说者的说辞。问题不是是否需要更多住房，而是一如既往地在于把住房建在哪里。在游说压力下，乔治·奥斯本偏好乡村新建项目，而不是城市改造和更新；他偏好城外购物区，而不是城镇主要商业街。这不是自由市场，而是一个偏向特定选择的市场。乡村城镇和村庄一直在发展，也将永远发展。如果建设紧靠其边缘，并尊重其特色，它们就能发展得最好。我们不会破坏城市保护区，为什么要破坏乡村保护区呢?

第 6 段

Development should be planned, not let rip. After the Netherlands, Britain is Europe’s most crowded country. Half a century of town and country planning has enabled it to retain an enviable rural coherence, while still permitting low-density urban living. There is no doubt of the alternative —the corrupted landscapes of southern Portugal, Spain or Ireland. Avoiding this rather than promoting it should unite the left and right of the political spectrum.

直译：开发应该有规划，而不应任其失控。英国是欧洲仅次于荷兰的人口最稠密的国家。半个世纪的城乡规划，使它既能保留令人羡慕的乡村整体协调性，又允许城市居民享有低密度居住环境。另一条道路会带来什么结果，毫无疑问：看看葡萄牙南部、西班牙或爱尔兰遭到破坏的景观就知道了。避免这种结果，而不是促成它，应当成为政治光谱中左右两派的共同目标。

Text 3

第 1 段

"There is one and only one social responsibility of business," wrote Milton Friedman, a Nobel prize-winning economist, "That is, to use its resources and engage in activities designed to increase its profits." But even if you accept Friedman's premise and regard corporate social responsibility (CSR) policies as a waste of shareholders' money, things may not be absolutely clear-cut. New research suggests that CSR may create monetary value for companies —at least when they are prosecuted for corruption.

直译：诺贝尔经济学奖得主米尔顿·弗里德曼曾写道："企业有且只有一种社会责任，那就是利用其资源，从事旨在增加利润的活动。"但是，即使你接受弗里德曼的前提，认为企业社会责任（CSR）政策是在浪费股东的钱，事情也未必完全黑白分明。新的研究表明，企业社会责任可能为公司创造金钱价值，至少在公司因腐败受到起诉时如此。

第 2 段

The largest firms in America and Britain together spend more than $15 billion a year on CSR, according to an estimate by EPG, a consulting firm. This could add value to their businesses in three ways. First, consumers may take CSR spending as a "signal" that a company's products are of high quality. Second, customers may be willing to buy a company's products as an indirect way to donate to the good causes it helps. And third, through a more diffuse "halo effect," whereby its good deeds earn it greater consideration from consumers and others.

直译：咨询公司 EPG 估计，美国和英国最大的企业每年在企业社会责任方面的支出，合计超过一百五十亿美元。这可能通过三种方式为企业增值。第一，消费者可能把企业社会责任支出视为公司产品质量高的"信号"。第二，顾客可能愿意购买一家公司的产品，借此间接向该公司支持的公益事业捐款。第三，通过一种更广泛的"光环效应"：企业的善举使它获得消费者和其他人更多的体谅。

第 3 段

Previous studies on CSR have had trouble differentiating these effects because consumers can be affected by all three. A recent study attempts to separate them by looking at bribery prosecutions under America's Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA). It argues that since prosecutors do not consume a company's products as part of their investigations, they could be influenced only by the halo effect.

直译：以往关于企业社会责任的研究，难以区分这些效应，因为消费者可能同时受到三者的影响。最近一项研究试图通过考察依据美国《反海外腐败法》（FCPA）提起的贿赂诉讼，将这些效应区分开来。研究认为，检察官在调查过程中并不消费公司的产品，因此他们只可能受到光环效应的影响。

第 4 段

The study found that, among prosecuted firms, those with the most comprehensive CSR programmes tended to get more lenient penalties. Their analysis ruled out the possibility that it was firms' political influence, rather than their CSR stand, that accounted for the leniency: Companies that contributed more to political campaigns did not receive lower fines.

直译：研究发现，在受到起诉的公司中，那些拥有最全面企业社会责任计划的公司，往往受到较为宽大的处罚。研究者的分析排除了这样一种可能：使公司获得宽待的，是其政治影响力而不是企业社会责任立场；因为向政治竞选捐款更多的公司，并没有得到更低的罚款。

第 5 段

In all, the study concludes that whereas prosecutors should only evaluate a case based on its merits, they do seem to be influenced by a company's record in CSR. "We estimate that either eliminating a substantial labour-rights concern, such as child labour, or increasing corporate giving by about 20% results in fines that generally are 40% lower than the typical punishment for bribing foreign officials," says one researcher.

直译：总体而言，该研究得出的结论是：尽管检察官本应仅根据案件本身的事实来评估案件，但他们似乎确实会受到公司企业社会责任记录的影响。一名研究者说："我们估计，无论是消除童工之类的重大劳工权利问题，还是把企业捐赠增加约百分之二十，都会使罚款通常比贿赂外国官员的典型处罚低百分之四十。"

第 6 段

Researchers admit that their study does not answer the question of how much businesses ought to spend on CSR. Nor does it reveal how much companies are banking on the halo effect, rather than the other possible benefits, when they decide their do-gooding policies. But at least they have demonstrated that when companies get into trouble with the law, evidence of good character can win them a less costly punishment.

直译：研究者承认，他们的研究没有回答企业究竟应该在企业社会责任方面花多少钱，也没有揭示：公司在决定行善政策时，在多大程度上寄望于光环效应，而非其他可能的好处。但是，他们至少已经证明，当公司触犯法律而陷入麻烦时，良好品行的证据可以为它们争取代价较小的处罚。

Text 4

第 1 段

There will eventually come a day when The New York Times ceases to publish stories on newsprint. Exactly when that day will be is a matter of debate. “Sometime in the future,” the paper’s publisher said back in 2010.

直译：终究会有一天，《纽约时报》不再用新闻纸刊登报道。那一天究竟何时到来，仍是一个有争议的问题。早在二○一○年，该报发行人就说过：“ 将来的某个时候。”

第 2 段

Nostalgia for ink on paper and the rustle of pages aside, there’s plenty of incentive to ditch print. The infrastructure required to make a physical newspaper —printing presses, delivery trucks —isn’t just expensive; it’s excessive at a time when online-only competitors don’t have the same set of financial constraints. Readers are migrating away from print anyway. And though print ad sales still dwarf their online and mobile counterparts, revenue from print is still declining.

直译：撇开人们对纸上油墨和翻页沙沙声的怀念，放弃纸质印刷有着充分的动力。制作实体报纸所需的基础设施——印刷机、送报卡车——不仅价格昂贵；在纯网络竞争者没有同样财务约束的时代，这些设施还显得过多。无论如何，读者正在远离纸质报刊。虽然纸媒广告销售额仍远高于网络和移动端的同类收入，但纸媒收入仍在下降。

第 3 段

Overhead may be high and circulation lower, but rushing to eliminate its print edition would be a mistake, says BuzzFeed CEO Jonah Peretti.

直译：BuzzFeed 首席执行官乔纳 · 佩雷蒂说，日常运营费用或许很高，发行量或许在下降，但匆忙取消纸质版会是一个错误。

第 4 段

Peretti says the Times shouldn’t waste time getting out of the print business, but only if they go about doing it the right way. “Figuring out a way to accelerate that transition would make sense for them,” he said, “but if you discontinue it, you’re going to have your most loyal customers really upset with you.”

直译：佩雷蒂说，《纽约时报》不应该在退出纸媒业务这件事上浪费时间，但前提是采取正确的方式。他说：“ 设法加快这一转型，对他们来说是有意义的。但是，如果你停办纸质版，就会使最忠实的顾客对你非常不满。”

第 5 段

Sometimes that’s worth making a change anyway. Peretti gives the example of Netflix discontinuing its DVD-mailing service to focus on streaming. “It was seen as a blunder,” he said. The move turned out to be foresighted. And if Peretti were in charge at the Times? “I wouldn’t pick a year to end print,” he said. “I would raise prices and make it into more of a legacy product.”

直译：有时，即便如此，作出改变仍然值得。佩雷蒂举了 Netflix 停止 DVD 邮寄服务、转而专注流媒体的例子。他说：“ 这曾被看作一个大错。” 事实证明，这一举措颇有远见。那么，如果佩雷蒂负责《纽约时报》，他会怎么做？他说：“ 我不会选定某一年结束纸质版。我会提高价格，把它更多地做成一种传承下来的传统产品。”

第 6 段

The most loyal customers would still get the product they favor, the idea goes, and they'd feel like they were helping sustain the quality of something they believe in. "So if you're overpaying for print, you could feel like you were helping," Peretti said. "Then increase it at a higher rate each year and essentially try to generate additional revenue." In other words, if you're going to make a print product, make it for the people who are already obsessed with it. Which may be what the Times is doing already. Getting the print edition seven days a week costs nearly $500 a year —more than twice as much as a digital-only subscription.

直译：按照这一想法，最忠实的顾客仍能买到自己喜爱的产品，而且他们会觉得，自己在帮助维持某种他们所信赖事物的品质。佩雷蒂说："所以，如果你为纸质版付了偏高的价格，你可能会觉得自己在提供帮助。然后每年以更高的幅度提价，实质上就是设法创造额外收入。"换句话说，如果你要做一种纸质产品，就为那些已经迷恋它的人去做。这或许正是《纽约时报》已经在做的。每周七天都收到纸质版，一年的费用接近五百美元，是纯数字订阅费用的两倍多。

第 7 段

"It's a really hard thing to do and it's a tremendous luxury that BuzzFeed doesn't have a legacy business," Peretti remarked. "But we're going to have questions like that where we have things we're doing that don't make sense when the market changes and the world changes. In those situations, it's better to be more aggressive than less aggressive."

直译：佩雷蒂评论道："这确实是一件很难做的事，而 BuzzFeed 没有遗留的传统业务，是一种极大的幸运。但我们也会面临类似问题：市场变化、世界变化时，我们正在做的某些事情将变得不再合理。在那些情形下，更积极进取一些，要好过不够积极。"